SpecTool Quick Start

Your first CSI Part 2 spec, start to finish. Basics only; for detail see the full *SpecTool User Guide* (section numbers below refer to it).

Before you start

- **AVTools Suite Pro** license or trial, in Revit 2025, 2026 or 2027. Ribbon: **BIM Acoustics** → **AV Tools** → **SpecTool** (press F1 on the button for its help page).
- **An internet connection.** SpecTool's AI steps (including Generate) run through the BIM Acoustics cloud service.
- **AV families placed in the model.** Loaded but unplaced families are ignored.
- **A Model value on every family Type** (ideally Manufacturer too). No Model, no product.
- **The architect's spec template** (.docx) for the format: styles, fonts, headers, footers, numbering.
- **Your boilerplate spec** (.docx) with Part 1 and Part 3. None for 27 41 00? Use the bundled UFGS starter.
- **A datasheet folder** of PDFs with the model number in each filename (e.g. `CO10 Data Sheet.pdf`), plus an output folder.

Your first spec in six screens

Home: pick a section

SpecTool scans the model and lists the spec sections your equipment needs, e.g. **27 41 00 Audio-Video Systems**. Click **Work on it** →. If one item has created a section of its own (a lone patchbay in 27 15 00), first click **Merge…** on that row to fold it into your main section.

Step 1: Setup

- Pick the **Section**; enter the **Phase** (e.g. `50% CD`) and **Issue date**.
- Leave **Detail level** on *User Boilerplate Detail* to match your own writing style.
- Choose the **template**, **boilerplate** (or **Use bundled starter…**), **datasheet folder** and **output folder**. All of it is remembered for the project.

Step 2: Products

- **Untick** anything that doesn't belong in this spec.
- Fix the **Category** on unclassified rows, or click **Classify unknowns (AI)**.
- Missing something? Check the **Skipped** banner (no Model value), **+ Add from model…** (families in other categories), or **+ Add manually…** (items not in the model).

Step 3: Data & Datasheets

Only products missing key specs appear. Most match a PDF in your datasheet folder automatically. For the rest use **From URL...** (a PDF or a product page), **Attach...**, or **Find datasheets on the web (AI)**. Anything still missing reads "as scheduled on the Drawings".

Step 4: Categories & Articles

Confirm each product lands in the right Part 2 article (Loudspeakers, Power Amplifiers, and so on). Corrections are remembered.

Step 5: Review & Generate

- Click **Generate with AI (preview)** and read the result. Untick paragraphs you don't want; edit text if needed.
- Click **Create / Update spec**, then **Open document**.

What you get

- A .docx in the template's format: Part 1 and Part 3 from your boilerplate, generated Part 2 **highlighted yellow for review**, and header/footer fields (section, title, phase, date) filled in.
- **Next issue:** run SpecTool again. It updates the last issued document and keeps your hand edits outside the Part 2 articles.

Five things that trip people up

- **A product is missing.** Not placed, no Model value, or its family is in a category the scan skips. Fix the family or use **+ Add from model...**.
- **Hand edits to Part 2 disappear.** Part 2 is regenerated on every Update. Fix the family's parameters or its datasheet and regenerate. Part 1 and Part 3 edits are safe.
- **Specs describe the wrong product.** The wrong datasheet matched. Check step 3; **Clear** resets a row.
- **Products don't classify.** Generic names like "Speaker3" can't be recognized. Assign the category once; it's remembered.
- **Values are thin.** Fill in the family's Type parameters or add the datasheet; model data is the biggest lever on spec quality (§1).

Next

Full *SpecTool User Guide*: §1 model data, §6 datasheets, §8 Create / Update, §9 detail levels. Questions: **support@bimacoustics.net**